PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
Board of Education
Wednesday, October 8, 2025

Facilities Improvement and Oversight Committee Meeting

Informal Meeting Minutes

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Facilities Improvement and Oversight Committee Meeting of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center , 501 N. Dixon St., Portland, OR 97227 and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Committee Members:
Committee Chair Virginia La Forte; Board Vice-Chair Michelle DePass; Director Rashelle Chase-Miller

Non-Committee Board Members:

Chair Eddie Wang; Directors Patte Sullivan and Stephanie Engelsman

Other Attendees:
Kara Bradshaw – Confidential Executive Assistant, Board Clerk
Jennifer Eggers – Structural Engineer, Holmes
Joanne Evenson – Director, Project Management and Construction
Dr. Jon Franco – Senior Chief of Operations
Deborah Kafoury – Chief of Staff
Liz Large – Contracted Senior Legal Advisor
Frank Leavitt – Senior Director, Operations
Rosanne Powell - Senior Board Manager
Robert Jole – Senior Project Manager
Sarah Norman – Interim Senior Director, Office of School Modernization
Sharon Toncray – Chief Legal Officer

Call to Order & Introductions

The meeting was called to order at 4:33 pm by Committee Chair La Forte. Attendees introduced themselves.

Public Comment

- Meghan Gaiero – Upgrade most dangerous schools first, create a seismic risk mitigation plan for schools.
- Sylvan Cambier – Upgrade schools to be seismically secure and combine upgrades creatively with other improvements to better benefit schools.
- John Dwyer – Represents Safe Structures PPS. Has concerns about the allocation weight in the seismic report. Urged the Board to ask questions about the plan.
- Dr. Effie Greathouse – Request to make HVAC issues a recurring agenda topic at every other meeting.
- Hillary Brown – Need to continue to improve upon temperature control solutions
- Emily Davidson – Highlighted cooling mitigation solutions that worked and areas that still need to be addressed at Jason Lee School.
- Katie Price – Request for the HVAC upgrades to be included on the Office of School Modernization webpage.
- Elijah Probst – Seismic safety concerns keep parents up at night, please work to reinforce buildings.

Center for Black Student Excellence

Time: 4:58 pm

Staff: Joanne Evenson and Liz Large

Staff provided an update on the due diligence progress for the purchase of the Center for Black Student Excellence (CBSE) building and the next steps, noting that there were no material concerns found in the survey nor the title report, and that staff is working on creating mitigation plans for any areas that may need them. Staff provided an overview of the initial review of operating costs, and next steps. Committee members asked questions, with topics including the road that goes between the two buildings and rental income.

Athletics

Time: 5:08 pm

Staff: Joanna Evenson

Staff provided an update on athletics capital projects, including the development of athletic hubs at Marshall High School and Jackson Middle School and planned improvements at several high schools, such as seating upgrades, field work, and lighting. Committee members asked questions about project timelines for Grant Bowl lighting installations. Staff provided an overview of the steps that need to be taken and vendor constraints. There was a request for more detailed athletic project information, with staff noting that a dashboard is being developed to provide more timely updates as schedules change.

Ida B. Wells-Barnett High School Revised Master Plan

Time: 5:20 pm

Stefee Knudsen – Bora Architects

Ms. Knudsen provided an overview of the Ida B Wells modernization budget summary, noting that the costs estimates have come in within the 1.5% range of hard costs after value engineering. The comprehensive plan will go to the Board in November. Committee members asked questions, including about the green energy tech costs, which are primarily for solar panels

Health and Safety Work Orders

Time: 5:27 pm

Staff: Frank Leavitt

Staff provided a summary of the district's maintenance operations, including staffing and scheduling, open work orders, and the maintenance priority matrix. Committee members asked questions, with topics including how to address low level maintenance needs.

Seismic Report Update

Time: 5:44 pm

Staff: Dr. Jon Franco

Staff provided an update on completed and ongoing seismic work, outlined plans for future improvements, and reviewed the prioritization formula that will inform a forthcoming recommendation to the Board. Staff noted plans to apply for a seismic improvement grant in November and shared that, while earlier starts were explored, current timelines point to two major sites beginning work in 2027, with some seismic upgrades being completed alongside current roofing projects through a hybrid approach of full retrofits and targeted improvements. Committee members asked questions about the request for proposal timeline, anticipated summer projects, and how seismic planning aligns with broader facility planning and right-sizing efforts.

Status Updates

Time: 5:57 pm

Staff: Dr. Jon Franco and Deborah Kafoury

Staff provided an update on several initiatives. Staff are working to ensure that they consider lessons learned in previous enrollment rebalancing initiatives to apply to the upcoming School Right Sizing project, noting that timing matters. Requests for Proposals are out for seismic upgrade projects. Staff plans to meet with representatives from the Ida B Wells Farmers Market to address safety concerns, potential delays, and cost impacts.

Other Business

Chair Wang requested that each committee add 10 minutes at the end of the meeting to talk about future agenda topics. The committee shared ideas for future topics, including a community lift project which would coordinate with outside partners with small maintenance projects that need to be completed

Adjourn

The meeting was adjourned at 6:14pm by committee chair La Forte.

Submitted by:
Kara Bradshaw
Confidential Executive Assistant / Board Clerk
Portland Public Schools